

Zero Beat



Kingsport Amateur Radio Club
September 2026 Edition

President Notes

Contesting 101 was the subject of our meeting for the month of September. Juan Lopez, AC6ZM, led us on a personal journey of how he got into Ham Radio and Contesting. After a short business meeting Juan shared his presentation for an hour and a half, answering questions along the way. He showed us that by far N1MM Logger is the world's most popular contest logging program. Having been on DZ-expeditions himself he shared some of the issues that had to be dealt while contesting in this manner. Some of our club members have interfaced with Juan on the air and can now put a face to this callsign. His wife is a ham and together they drive around the country chasing contest points. Interest was high and not one club member left early. We want to thank Justin Compton for bringing this exciting meeting to our club!!! And we need to thank Matt Babler, who had just arrived home from a business trip and then left home to set up Microsoft Team so that we and those that remotely signed in could see the presentation!!!

Several of us went to the Hamfest in Dandridge and were surprised at how nice the facilities were and how large the crowd was that attended. Peter Stuart sold most of what he wanted to sell. John Williams purchased a new radio and we became aware of a "new to us" form of communication called TENNMESH. There were lots of local vendors inside and many tailgaters outside, which encourages us to come back next year!!!

The W4DXCC DX and Contest Convention is being held in Pigeon Forge this Saturday, September 19. Although I am not a contester, I have enjoyed attending this event for years. It's always interesting, I always learn new things and the folks there are friendly. Come join in!!! <https://www.w4dxcc.org/>

Sincerely,

Larry Dale KD4FTN

President

Club News

The KARC foxhunt will take place on September 19th. It begins at 3 p.m. And check-ins starting at 2:45 p.m. On the 146.970 repeater. Participants can start from any location in the area, keeping in mind that the foxes will be hidden within the city limits, so having a map on your phone is advisable. All fox frequencies are listed on the [W4TRC.org website](http://W4TRC.org). If you are interested in joining the first trip, please contact Josh Carmack or Justin Compton to arrange a ride. Their phone numbers and email addresses are also available on the website.

HHART & KARC meets at Randall's every 3rd Wednesday of the month from 10:00 AM- 12:00 PM.

We need Net Control volunteers for our Sunday Evening 2 Meter Net! No monthly commitment – just sign up for the weeks you want. We're looking for both a primary and backup Net Control operator each week.

Not sure what a net is? It's a scheduled on-air gathering where licensed hams check in, share information, and stay connected with the local community. Whether you're newly licensed or a seasoned operator, it's one of the best ways to stay active in the hobby – and running Net Control is a great way to give back!

Sign-up, schedule & net script: <https://w4trc.org/nets>
Questions: netcontrol@w4trc.org

Amateur Radio News

Former ARRL C00 Harold R. Kramer, WJ1B, Silent Key. Former ARRL Chief Operating Officer Harold Kramer, WJ1B, passed away on Monday, August 31, 2026. [Continue Reading](#)

Answering the Call: A 9/11 Remembrance from ARRLn New York City, radio amateurs (also known as hams) took to the airwaves within minutes of the attacks on the World Trade Center, and emergency nets were active – and busy – for nearly two weeks afterward, with nearly 500 hams in total. [Continue Reading](#)

Video: Educator Shows How Amateur Radio Is Inspiring Students. Educator Everton Henriques, KD2ZZT, shared his experience using amateur radio to inspire students and bring engineering and technology to life in the classroom during his keynote at the 2026 ARRL New England Division Convention. [Continue Reading](#)

Special HAARP Transmission for 9/11. To commemorate the 25th anniversary of the Sep. 11, 2001 attacks on the US, the High-frequency Active Auroral Research Program (HAARP) at the University of Alaska Fairbanks will be making a special transmission on 9.11 MHz at 0030-0035 UTC, Sep. 12, 2026. [Continue Reading](#)

APRS Connect: A Messaging-First APRS Client for Android, Free Over APRS-ISA new APRS client for Android, built around conversations rather than a packet console. [Continue Reading](#)

HAARP Notice of Transmission. Actual transmit days and times may be highly variable. [Continue Reading](#)

SafecomLink for Pactor – Hamradio Edition Launches in the WiMo Store. A software platform, purpose-built for Pactor. [Continue Reading](#)

Activate All RI POTA Event. Event aims to activate all 61 Rhode Island parks. [Continue Reading](#)

Fire Prevention Week Special Event Highlights Fire Safety. Event focuses specifically on charging lithium-ion batteries. [Continue Reading](#)

HelioClock Review: An In-Depth Look at a Well-Crafted Situational Awareness Display. A beautiful and well-designed display piece that gives Geochron a run for both its price and design. [Continue Reading](#)

HamRadioWeb Offers Remote FT8 Operation.Works on phone and PC. No port forwarding or VPN required. [Continue Reading](#)

Brugtgrej.dk is Denmark's Premier Marketplace for Used Ham Radio Gear.Hams may also be interested in their discussion forums and dashboard. [Continue Reading](#)

The next version of the M17 specification.The proposed V3 meets the goals set out for it, but are there any downsides? [Continue Reading](#)

AST SpaceMobile's 800 MHz trial wraps up – But the 70cm interference story isn't going away.Monitoring data from the SATNOGS network has reportedly shown AST operating with interference to the 70cm Amateur allocation. [Continue Reading](#)

FCC regulations and MeshCore 500.We, along with many in the Meshtastic community, recently found out that most of Meshtastic's presets are not in compliance with the FCC. [Continue Reading](#)

Which downlink? An open trade study of candidate bands for futureGEO.If the host cannot offer 3 cm, 6 cm (5830–5850 MHz) is the strongest fallback on physics. [Continue Reading](#)

A Lewis & Clark POTA journey.The main idea is to do a road trip, starting in St Louis, near the Gateway Arch and follow 3,700 miles of river, prairie, mountain, and forest to the Pacific Ocean. [Continue Reading](#)

PARC: Protected Area Radio Community.PARC Community® is the new Amateur Radio park activation program. Simple, accessible, and open to all Radio Amateurs worldwide. [Continue Reading](#)

Improving the "Titanic" 40m field expedient backpack portable antenna.The revised "Titanic" antenna's sloping top hat wires are supported on trekking poles, although raising the ends higher does improve the SWR. [Continue Reading](#)

A few things that have made my POTA spots easier and better.I've done a lot of experimenting and I finally landed on a set-up that works for me. [Continue Reading](#)

Putting my AllStar node on 44Net.Here is how that went, including the parts that did not go well. [Continue Reading](#)

Call sign WB4MZ0 (numeral zero).An FCC error gave one club a unique call sign. [Continue Reading](#)

Hamfests/Conventions – Let's Go !

09/19/2026 – W4DXCC by SEDCO, Location: Pigeon Forge, Sponsor:
SEDCO Website: <http://www.w4dxcc.org>

SKYWARN

If you are interested in being a SKYWARN Storm Spotter, please visit <https://www.weather.gov/mrx/skywarn>

To join our area SKYWARN organization, which is the Northeast Tennessee District 7 SKYWARN, please visit their website <https://www.skywarn7.org/>

The Importance of NOAA Weather Radios and Why You Should Own One. [Continue Reading](#)

Important Information

President: Larry Dale (KD4FTN)

Vice President: Justin Compton (K04DCD)

Treasurer: Rick Curtis (W4BXL)

Secretary: Christina Compton (KQ4CDM)

Repeater Trustee: Joshua Carmack (N4JHC)

The club meetings will be held on the second Thursday of each month at Eastman's Toy F. Reid Employee Center; Room 219; 400 S. Wilcox Dr; Kingsport, TN 37660 at 7:00 PM. Everyone is welcome to attend.

Club Repeaters, located on Bays Mountain 2 Meter: 146.970 MHz (-) PL Tone 123.0 Hz (Analog or Yaesu System Fusion C4FM Input / Analog Only Output) Echolink: W4TRC-R

70 Centimeters: 443.325 MHz (+) PL Tone 123.0 Hz (Automatic Mode Select (AMS) for Yaesu System Fusion C4FM and Analog FM)

70 Centimeters: 443.175 (+) (Yaesu System Fusion C4FM Only)

Sunday Night Informational Net on 146.970 MHz at 8:30 PM Eastern Time.

For more information about the KARC and amateur radio, please visit our website at www.w4trc.org or email us at contact@w4trc.org

Erik McCord, WX4ET, is the editor of Zero Beat, a monthly newsletter.